CHESS COACH READY™

BONUS 2 OF 5

Tactical Correction & Coaching Cue Library™

Hundreds of practical coaching cues and correction systems for sharpening tactical execution.

Welcome to Bonus 2

Every coach knows the moment: your student blunders a fork, misses a pin, or plays the first move they see — and you reach for correction language that comes out vague, repetitive, or too slow. "Look for tactics" doesn't build skill. "Why didn't you check for forks?" doesn't give a student a tool. This library exists because the moment of error is the highest-leverage teaching moment in any chess lesson, and you need sharp, ready language to meet it.

This bonus is a quick-reference cue bank — not a curriculum to read through, but a coaching tool to **reach for mid-lesson**. It delivers hundreds of precise, tested coaching cues organized by the exact tactical error being made, so you never have to improvise your correction language again.

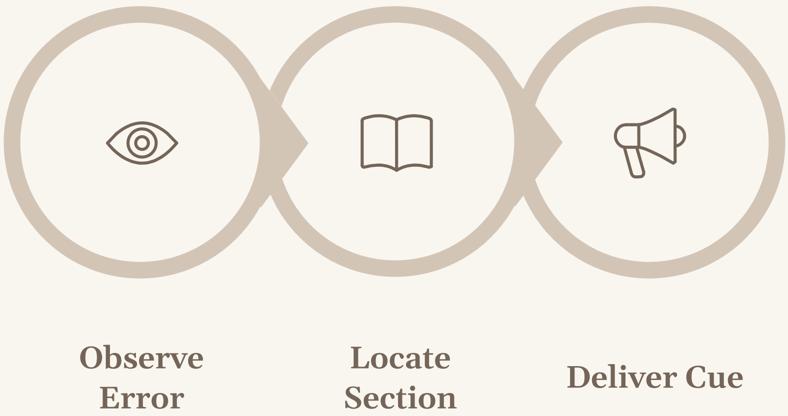
What You'll Walk Away With

- Ready-to-speak correction cues for every major tactical error
- Pattern-specific language for forks, pins, skewers, discovered attacks, and combined threats
- Cues for calculation failures, visualization breakdowns, and decision-making errors
- A blank template to build your own personal cue system over time

Bonus 2: Tactical Correction & Coaching Cue Library™

How to Use This Library

This bonus is designed as a **companion reference to Module 2: Tactical & Calculation Progression System™**. Where Module 2 gives you a full teaching curriculum — sequenced lessons, exercises, and skill progressions — this library gives you the in-the-moment language to correct what you're already seeing in your student's play. Think of Module 2 as the roadmap and this library as the toolbox you carry with you every session.



The library is organized by **error type**, not by student level. A 600-rated beginner and a 1600-rated tournament player can make the same conceptual mistake — missing a knight fork because they're not scanning all pieces simultaneously. The cue is the same; the follow-up depth adjusts to the student.

Section 2

Pattern Recognition Cues — Forks, Pins, Skewers, Discovered Attacks, Combined Patterns

Section 3

Calculation & Visualization Cues — Early stopping, missed forcing moves, visualization breakdowns

Section 4

Candidate-Move & Decision Cues — First-move bias, one-move thinking

Section 5

Closing Tools — Cue selection guide, blank template, and closing note

Fork Correction Cues — Part 1

A fork is the most teachable tactical pattern in chess — and one of the most consistently missed at every level below master. The cues below target the three most common fork failures: not scanning for fork geometry, not counting attacked pieces, and not creating the fork square deliberately.

Error: Student misses a knight fork that was available

> "Before your knight moves anywhere, ask yourself: where can it jump to, and how many pieces does it touch from there?"

Why it works: Forces a scanning habit rather than reactive, single-destination thinking. The student learns to evaluate fork squares before choosing a square.

Error: Student sees one target piece but not both

> "Name all the pieces your opponent has that are undefended or unequal in value right now. Then ask: can any piece of yours reach two of those at once?"

Why it works: Separates target identification from move selection — the correct sequence for fork spotting.

Error: Student knows forks exist but doesn't look for them proactively

> "Add a fork check to your move routine — after you calculate your move, ask 'does this position let me attack two things at once?'"

Why it works: Embeds fork awareness into the student's existing decision loop without replacing it.

Fork Correction Cues — Part 2

The next set of fork cues addresses students who conceptually understand forks but fail to create the conditions for them — clearing squares, luring pieces, or preparing the geometry over multiple moves.

Error: Student doesn't set up the fork — plays a fork that isn't there yet

> "The fork square doesn't exist yet — your opponent's piece is blocking it. What's the move that removes that piece, and then what does the position look like?"

Why it works: Teaches the critical distinction between a fork that's ready to execute and a fork that needs to be prepared — building multi-move calculation.

Error: Student sees a fork square but doesn't see that it's defended

> "Before you jump, check: can your piece safely land there? Count the defenders on that square before committing."

Why it works: Addresses the most costly fork error — playing into a defended square and losing the forking piece.

Error: Student confuses a double attack with a true fork

> "A fork wins material because one of those attacked pieces can't be saved in time. After you play the move, can your opponent save both? Walk me through it."

Why it works: Reinforces that a fork must be immediately decisive or it's just a tempo loss — precision of concept matters.

Cue Delivery Tip: For fork cues, always pause after delivering the cue and let the student scan silently for 30–60 seconds before offering any further guidance. The silence is the work.

Pin & Skewer Correction Cues — Part 1

Pins and skewers both exploit piece alignment — but students often conflate them or miss their key difference: a pin immobilizes a lesser piece protecting a greater one; a skewer forces the greater piece to move, exposing the lesser. These cues sharpen the distinction and fix the most common errors in identifying and exploiting alignment.

Error: Student doesn't notice pieces are on the same file, rank, or diagonal

> "Look at your opponent's pieces — are any two of them sitting on the same line? A rank, file, or diagonal? That line is always worth examining."

Why it works: Teaches the visual habit of scanning for alignment before looking for the attacking piece — the correct direction for pin/skewer recognition.

Error: Student sees a pin but doesn't exploit it — plays an unrelated move

> "Your bishop is already pinning that knight. Now ask: can you pile pressure on the pinned piece before your opponent escapes? Pile means more attackers."

Why it works: Moves the student from recognition to exploitation — the two-step sequence that turns awareness into material gain.

Error: Student tries to pin a piece that is already adequately defended

> "The pin only wins if you can increase the pressure faster than they can increase the defense. Count the attackers versus the defenders on that pinned piece right now."

Why it works: Prevents the common error of setting up a pin that accomplishes nothing — teaches material counting within the pin.

Pin & Skewer Correction Cues — Part 2

This set focuses on skewer-specific errors and the failure to use the correct long-range piece — bishop, rook, or queen — to set up both patterns. Many students under-activate their long-range pieces and miss skewer opportunities as a result.

Error: Student confuses a pin with a skewer — tries to pin the king

> "When the king is on the line, that's a skewer, not a pin. The king has to move — now what's behind it? That's the piece you're actually winning."

Why it works: Clarifies terminology with practical consequence — the student learns to look past the first piece, not stop at it.

Error: Student misses a skewer because the king is not obviously exposed

> "Imagine a laser beam from your rook along that file. Where does it end up? Does it reach the king — even several squares away?"

Why it works: The laser visualization is concrete and kinesthetic — it works for visual learners and slows down the scan to the right speed.

Error: Student abandons a pin when the opponent threatens to break it

> "They're threatening to break the pin — but before they do, can you extract value from it? Is there a move that wins material before the pin disappears?"

Why it works: Teaches time-sensitivity — pins and skewers are temporary weapons, and the question is always 'how much can I win before the clock runs out?'

Discovered Attack Correction Cues — Part 1

Discovered attacks are among the most powerful and most under-used tactical weapons at the intermediate level. The error is almost always the same: students see their moving piece, but don't see what the piece *behind* it is doing when the line clears. These cues teach students to read both the moving piece and the uncovering piece simultaneously.

Error: Student moves a piece without noticing it was blocking a line for another piece

> "Every time you move a piece, ask: what was that piece covering? What can now see through that square that couldn't before?"

Why it works: Reverses the default attention direction — from 'where am I going?' to 'what does my departure reveal?' — the essential mindset shift for discovered attack awareness.

Error: Student sees a discovered attack possibility but picks the wrong moving piece

> "The piece in front matters too. When you pull it away, can it do something threatening on its own? A discovered attack with a check or threat from the moving piece is twice as powerful."

Why it works: Elevates understanding from 'revealed attack' to 'double threat' — the student learns to optimize both the move and the revelation.

Error: Student fails to see an opponent's discovered attack coming

> "Look at every piece your opponent has that is blocked by one of their own pieces on the same line. If that blocker moves — anywhere — what does it unlock?"

Why it works: Builds defensive discovered attack awareness using the same scanning habit as the offensive version — one skill, two applications.

Discovered Attack Correction Cues — Part 2

These cues address the deeper failure mode: students who recognize the pattern in isolation but cannot execute it in a real position because the discovered attack is hidden behind a pawn structure or requires multi-move preparation.

Error: Student misses a discovered check as the most powerful resource

> "There's a check hiding here — not from the moving piece, but from what it reveals. Find the discovered check, then decide if it's better than the direct threats."

Why it works: Discovered checks are the highest-priority variant. Naming them explicitly forces the student to check for this specific resource before settling for less.

Error: Student doesn't see that a pawn advance creates a discovered attack

> "What's behind that pawn right now? If the pawn advances or captures, what does the piece behind it suddenly see? Is any of that dangerous for your opponent?"

Why it works: Pawns are the most overlooked blocking pieces. This cue specifically extends the student's scan to pawn moves, not just piece moves.

Error: Student prepares a discovered attack but telegraphs it with an obvious setup move

> "Your setup move is the one your opponent will read first. Can you make the preparation move threatening on its own, so they have to react to it rather than see through it?"

Why it works: Teaches concealment — the most lethal discovered attacks are prepared under cover of independent threats.

Double Attack & Combined-Pattern Cues — Part 1

Double attacks — where a single move creates two simultaneous threats — are the tactical engine of master-level play. The challenge for students is that combined patterns require holding multiple threats in mind at once, which demands both pattern recognition and working-memory capacity. These cues build that capacity through targeted language.

Error: Student sees one threat but not the second threat created by the same move

> "That move does more than one thing. Say out loud every threat it creates — all of them. Don't stop at the first one you see."

Why it works: Verbalizing forces completeness. Students who speak threats aloud catch the second threat far more often than those who calculate silently.

Error: Student plays a double threat move but the opponent has a move that answers both at once

> "Before you play it — can they answer both threats with the same move? If their king moves and defends both, your double threat isn't really a double threat yet."

Why it works: Teaches threat independence — for a double attack to work, the two threats must not share a single refutation. This check prevents most double-attack failures.

Error: Student sees a fork AND a pin in the position but plays neither

> "There's more than one tactical weapon available here. Which one wins more material? Rank the options before you pick."

Why it works: Prevents premature commitment when multiple patterns coexist — moves the student toward comparing tactical options, not just finding one.

Double Attack & Combined-Pattern Cues — Part 2

This final set of Section 2 cues covers the rarest and most advanced combined-pattern errors: students who execute one pattern correctly but miss the follow-up combinational resource that converts material advantage into a decisive win.

Error: Student wins a piece with a fork but misses the follow-up tactic on the resulting position

> "After you capture, recalculate from scratch. What does the new position look like? Don't assume the game is decided — ask: is there more here?"

Why it works: Combos require continuous calculation. The most common mistake after winning material is stopping — this cue keeps the engine running.

Error: Student fails to see that a combined pin-and-fork sequence is available

> "First pin it — so it can't move. Now fork it. The pin sets the table; the fork is the meal. Which piece creates the pin, and which creates the fork?"

Why it works: Gives the student a verbal recipe — a two-step formula — for the most common combined-pattern structure. Formulas reduce working memory load.

Error: Student over-complicates a position with many patterns available — plays randomly

> "There's a lot going on here, and that's good. Slow down. Start with checks, then captures, then threats — in that order. What forcing moves exist first?"

Why it works: Restores order in a complex position by imposing the classic candidate-move hierarchy: checks, captures, threats. Works at any level.

Cues for Students Who Stop Calculating Too Early — Part 1

The single most common calculation error at every level below expert is stopping one move short. Students quit the line just before the critical forcing move that decides the game. These cues address the psychological and habitual roots of premature calculation — and give you the language to pull the student back in and keep them calculating.

Error: Student evaluates a position after two moves as "unclear" and abandons the line

> "'Unclear' isn't a calculation result — it's a stopping point. Push one more move. Is there a forcing move in this position that changes the evaluation? Check, capture, or threat?"

Why it works: Replaces a vague assessment with a concrete instruction. Students who label positions 'unclear' are often stopping exactly where the key resource lives.

Error: Student calculates to a quiet position and stops, missing the follow-up threat

> "You've reached a quiet-looking position in your calculation — but ask: does your opponent have a threat here? If they do, what are you going to do about it? Calculate one more move."

Why it works: Teaches the student to calculate through silence, not just through forcing moves. Quiet positions in a line can still contain decisive follow-ups.

Error: Student stops calculating because the position "looks" roughly equal

> "Don't evaluate by feel yet. Can your opponent recapture? After they do, do you have another move? Walk all the way through the sequence before you score it."

Why it works: Separates appearance from calculation. Intuitive assessment is a shortcut — these cues insist on replacing it with sequence completion.

Cues for Students Who Stop Calculating Too Early — Part 2

This second set addresses students who have adequate calculation depth in easy positions but collapse under time pressure or in positions with many branching lines. These cues help coaches redirect the student to the most important branch rather than asking them to calculate everything.

Error: Student abandons a promising line because it has too many variations to calculate

> "You don't have to calculate every branch. What is your opponent's best defensive move? Calculate just that line first. If it works against their best, you're done — play it."

Why it works: Introduces the concept of prioritizing the opponent's best reply — a key efficiency tool that collapses the calculation tree to its critical path.

Error: Student stops calculating when they lose track of piece positions mid-line

> "You lost the position in your head — that's fine. Reset. Go back one move in the line and rebuild the picture from there. Piece by piece, square by square."

Why it works: Normalizes the reset without shame — restarting from a known point is a professional calculation skill, not a failure.

Error: Student quits promising calculation lines out of habit, not genuine evaluation

> "How many moves did you actually calculate in that line? Count them. One? Two? Tournament players calculate four to six forced moves as a baseline. Let's add one more move each time."

Why it works: Makes the depth explicit — the student becomes aware of their actual calculation depth and has a concrete, measurable target to improve it.

Depth-Building Protocol: After delivering these cues, assign a weekly calculation challenge: 3 positions where the student must push their calculation exactly one move deeper than feels comfortable. Track depth over time.

Cues for Students Who Miss Forcing Moves — Part 1

Checks, captures, and direct threats are the forcing moves that define tactical calculation. Students who miss them are typically scanning too broadly — looking at the whole board at once instead of applying the forcing-moves-first discipline. These cues rebuild the correct search hierarchy and make it habitual.

Error: Student plays a developing move when a winning capture is available

> "Before you develop anything — can you capture something right now? If yes, should you? Always ask what captures are available before asking what development is available."

Why it works: Installs the captures-first discipline without sacrificing positional thinking. The student learns to clear forcing moves from the agenda before turning to strategy.

Error: Student misses a check that forces the opponent's king into a losing position

> "Scan every piece you have: can any of them give check right now? A check forces a response — it's always the first thing to look for in a sharp position."

Why it works: Making a check scan habitual is one of the highest-ROI tactical skills a student can develop. This cue triggers the scan explicitly.

Error: Student sees a check but dismisses it as "just a check" without calculating it

> "Never skip a check without calculating it first — even if it looks pointless. Where does the king go? And after that, what do you have? Some checks are the first move of a combination."

Why it works: Eliminates the most costly shortcut in tactical play — the assumed refutation. Students who calculate every check catch far more combinations than those who filter intuitively.

Cues for Students Who Miss Forcing Moves — Part 1

Beyond checks and captures, students routinely fail to identify direct threats — moves that create a specific danger requiring an immediate response. These cues teach students to recognize what constitutes a real threat and to prioritize it in their calculation sequence.

Error: Student fails to see that a move creates a threat requiring an immediate response

> "What does your opponent's last move threaten? Not what it moved — what does it now attack, create, or enable? If you can't answer in one sentence, look again before you play."

Why it works: Shifts the student from move-reaction mode to threat-reading mode. The inability to articulate the threat is a signal that calculation hasn't begun yet.

Error: Student creates a threat but plays it without confirming the threat is actually forcing

> "You're threatening to win the rook. But can they simply ignore it and play a stronger threat of their own? A threat is only forcing if their best move is to answer it."

Why it works: Teaches the critical concept of threat quality — not all threats are forcing, and playing a non-forcing threat can cost a tempo in a critical position.

Error: Student misses a discovered threat because they focus only on the moving piece

> "After you play that move, what does the piece that didn't move now threaten? Sometimes the real threat is the piece you left behind, not the one you moved."

Why it works: Extends threat scanning to include pieces that are newly activated by a move — the exact mechanism of discovered attacks applied to threat identification.

Visualization Breakdown Cues — Part 1

Visualization — the ability to maintain an accurate mental image of the board position through a sequence of moves — is the engine of tactical calculation. When it breaks down, students either lose the position mid-line or, worse, calculate with an incorrect position and reach false conclusions. These cues target the specific breakdown points.

Error: Student miscalculates because they place a piece on the wrong square in their mental image

> "Describe the position out loud after move three in your line. Which pieces have moved, and where are they? Speaking the position aloud catches misplacement errors before they cost you."

Why it works: Verbalization creates a second verification channel — students who narrate their calculation catch significantly more misplacement errors than those who visualize silently.

Error: Student loses track of a captured piece and calculates as if it's still on the board

> "After each capture in your line, confirm out loud: that piece is gone. Removed from the board. Now what does the position look like without it? Don't let ghost pieces haunt your calculation."

Why it works: Ghost pieces — captured pieces still being treated as present — are the single most common visualization error. Making capture acknowledgment explicit eliminates it.

Error: Student can visualize two moves ahead but the board image collapses at move three

> "Let's build your calculation in layers. Tell me what the board looks like after move one only. Good — now add move two. Now add move three. Don't jump ahead; add one move at a time."

Why it works: Layered visualization training is the most effective method for extending depth. It prevents the common failure of trying to see the final position directly without building the sequence step by step.

Visualization Breakdown Cues — Part 2

This second set addresses visualization failures that occur in positions with many simultaneous piece interactions — where the student loses track of multiple pieces at once or confuses the trajectory of two converging pieces.

Error: Student confuses which piece is on which square after a series of exchanges

> "Let's slow the sequence down. After the first exchange, tell me exactly what is on that square. Then the second. Exchanges are the hardest moment in visualization — slow down precisely there."

Why it works: Exchange sequences are where most visualization collapses. Deliberate deceleration at the exchange point trains the mental habit of re-anchoring after captures.

Error: Student can't visualize a rook or queen moving across multiple squares in a line

> "Trace the rook's path square by square in your head — not from start to end, but one square at a time. Does it pass through any occupied square? Check each stop before you arrive."

Why it works: Long-range piece visualization requires a waypoint system. Moving square by square catches interceptions that end-to-end visualization misses entirely.

Error: Student abandons a strong line because the visualization is too complex

> "The complexity is the signal, not the stop sign. Complex positions often mean you're close to something decisive. Simplify one step at a time — which pieces are actually relevant to this line? Remove the rest from your mental picture."

Why it works: Teaches selective visualization — expert calculators narrow the mental board to the pieces that matter in the current line. This dramatically reduces cognitive load.

Cues for First-Move-Bias — Part 1

First-move bias — playing the first candidate that looks good without comparing it to alternatives — is one of the most persistent and expensive decision-making failures in chess. It's not a knowledge gap; it's a discipline gap. These cues install the comparison habit and replace impulsive move selection with a structured evaluation process.

Error: Student plays the first move that "feels right" without generating other candidates

> "Hold that move. Before you commit — can you name two other moves worth considering? Just name them. You don't have to calculate them fully yet. The rule is: never play the first move you see without naming at least two alternatives."

Why it works: The act of naming alternatives is cognitively sufficient to break first-move bias. Students who generate two alternatives choose significantly better moves even when they return to the original candidate.

Error: Student generates candidates but evaluates them in the wrong order — least forcing first

> "Order your candidates before you analyze them. Start with the most forcing — checks, captures, threats. Then quiet moves. Analyzing in the right order saves calculation time and catches the winning move first."

Why it works: Candidate ordering is a professional efficiency skill. Analyzing forcing moves first collapses the decision tree quickly — if a forcing line wins, the quiet moves become irrelevant.

Error: Student generates good candidates but picks the most familiar-looking one rather than the best one

> "Which of your candidates wins the most? Not which one looks most like a normal chess move — which one leaves your position best after your opponent's best response? Evaluate, don't match patterns."

Why it works: Pattern familiarity bias is the intermediate player's trap — choosing the move that looks 'chess-like' over the move that's objectively superior. This cue forces evaluation over recognition.

Cues for First-Move-Bias — Part 2

The second layer of first-move-bias correction addresses students who intellectually understand the candidate-move process but collapse under time pressure or in positions that feel urgent. These cues are designed for tournament-applicable use — brief, high-pressure scenarios where the student must maintain discipline.

Error: Student abandons candidate generation under time pressure and reverts to first-move bias

> "Even with two minutes on the clock, you have time for one more look. Ask yourself just one question: is there a check or capture I haven't considered? Twenty seconds. Go."

Why it works: Compresses the candidate-generation step into a single forcing-moves scan — the minimum viable discipline that catches the most common blunders in time pressure.

Error: Student generates candidates, starts comparing, then reverts to the first candidate when comparison is difficult

> "You came back to your first idea — which is fine, but only after you've proved it's best. Has your second candidate been fully calculated? What happens to it after your opponent's best reply?"

Why it works: Makes the return to the original candidate a conscious decision rather than a default. The student must complete the comparison before selecting — preventing the pseudo-deliberation trap.

Error: Student plays a candidate move that is clearly second-best when a simple winning move exists

> "The winning move was simpler than what you played. When there's a clear, forcing winning sequence — take it. Complexity in a winning position is your enemy, not your advantage."

Why it works: Corrects the opposite of first-move bias — over-complication bias. Students who miss simple winning moves because they're looking for something clever need this correction explicitly.

Cues for One-Move Thinking — Part 1

One-move thinking — playing a good-looking move without asking 'what does my opponent do next?' — is the tactical equivalent of planning a journey to the edge of the map and then stopping. These cues install the opponent-modeling habit at every stage of calculation, from the simplest tactics to multi-move combinations.

Error: Student plays a tactical move without asking what the opponent's best response is

> "Before you play — what's your opponent's best reply? Not their most obvious reply, their best. If you can't answer that, you haven't finished calculating."

Why it works: Makes opponent-modeling a non-negotiable step in the calculation sequence. The question 'what's their best reply?' is the single most powerful anti-blunder tool available.

Error: Student assumes the opponent will cooperate with the intended threat

> "Play it from your opponent's side for a moment. If your opponent sat down in your chair, what would they do? They're not going to walk into your threat — what's their escape?"

Why it works: Perspective-switching is one of the most effective cognitive tools in chess coaching. Students who can model the opponent's side calculate more accurately than those who remain in their own chair.

Error: Student plays a combination that works unless the opponent has one specific defensive resource — which they do

> "Your combination assumed that move wasn't available to them. Before you commit to a combination, ask: is there any defensive resource — even one — that refutes it? Find it before they do."

Why it works: Teaches defensive resource scanning — looking for the opponent's saving move before committing to the combination. This is the habit that separates accurate tacticians from brilliant-but-incorrect ones.

Cues for One-Move Thinking — Part 2

This final Section 4 set addresses the advanced manifestation of one-move thinking: students who correctly answer the first opponent reply but fail to calculate the second and third, creating combinations that are refuted two moves deep.

Error: Student calculates opponent's reply correctly but misses the opponent's second defensive move

> "You answered their first defensive move. Good. Now they have another move — what is it? Don't stop at their first reply. Push one more level: what do they do after you respond to their response?"

Why it works: Extends opponent modeling to two levels deep — the minimum required for most combinations at the intermediate and advanced level.

Error: Student plays a winning attack but allows a counter-threat they haven't calculated

> "You're attacking — but they may be attacking too. While you're calculating your attack, ask once: does your opponent have a counter-threat that requires an immediate response? If yes, does your attacking move also handle that threat, or does it ignore it?"

Why it works: Dual-purpose move evaluation — checking whether an attacking move also neutralizes counter-threats — is a hallmark of precise tactical play. This cue installs it explicitly.

Error: Student plays a sequence that requires the opponent to make a specific passive reply to succeed

> "Your line only works if they play passively. Assume they'll find their sharpest, most active reply. Does your combination still hold? If not, find the version that does — or find a different combination."

Why it works: Forces the student to stress-test their calculation against the opponent's optimal play — the most demanding and most accurate standard of tactical evaluation.

Cue Selection Guide — Part 1

Use this quick-reference guide mid-lesson to find the right cue for what you're observing in your student's play. Match the student error in plain language to the section and cue that addresses it.

What You're Observing	Pattern Type	Go To
Student misses a knight fork that was sitting there	Fork recognition	Section 2 — Pages 4–5
Student sees fork geometry but plays into a defended square	Fork execution	Section 2 — Page 5
Student doesn't notice pieces are aligned on a rank, file, or diagonal	Pin / Skewer recognition	Section 2 — Page 6
Student sets up a pin but doesn't exploit it before opponent escapes	Pin exploitation	Section 2 — Page 6
Student confuses pin and skewer — tries to pin the king	Pin/Skewer distinction	Section 2 — Page 7
Student moves a piece without seeing what it was blocking	Discovered attack recognition	Section 2 — Page 8
Student misses a discovered check as a resource	Discovered check	Section 2 — Page 9
Student sees one threat created by a move but not both	Double attack recognition	Section 2 — Page 10
Student plays a combination but misses a follow-up tactic	Combined patterns	Section 2 — Page 11

Cue Selection Guide — Part 2

Continued quick-reference guide for calculation, visualization, and decision-making errors.

What You're Observing	Error Category	Go To
Student labels a position "unclear" and stops calculating	Premature calculation stop	Section 3 — Pages 12–13
Student collapses calculation depth under time pressure	Time-pressure calculation	Section 3 — Page 13
Student plays a development move when a capture exists	Missed forcing moves — captures	Section 3 — Pages 14–15
Student skips a check without calculating it	Missed forcing moves — checks	Section 3 — Page 14
Student can't explain what their opponent's last move threatens	Missed threat reading	Section 3 — Page 15
Student misplaces a piece in their mental image during calculation	Visualization — misplacement	Section 3 — Pages 16–17
Student calculates with a captured piece still on the board (ghost piece)	Visualization — ghost pieces	Section 3 — Page 16
Student plays the first move they see without naming alternatives	First-move bias	Section 4 — Pages 18–19
Student doesn't ask what the opponent's best reply is	One-move thinking	Section 4 — Pages 20–21
Student's combination fails because of a defensive resource they didn't consider	Defensive resource blindness	Section 4 — Page 21

Build Your Own Cue — Personal Coaching Language Template

Every coach develops signature language over time — phrases that land precisely for the students they know, in the contexts they teach in most often. Use this template to capture and systematize your own personal coaching cues as you discover them. A cue library that includes your own language is more powerful than one that only includes someone else's.

Field	Your Entry
Student Error	Describe the specific tactical or calculation error in plain language. What are you observing the student do or fail to do?
Student Level	Beginner / Intermediate / Advanced / All Levels
Pattern Category	Fork / Pin / Skewer / Discovered Attack / Double Attack / Calculation / Visualization / Candidate Moves / One-Move Thinking / Other
Your Cue	Write the exact phrase you use — word for word, as you would say it out loud in a lesson. Put it in quotes.
Why It Works	One sentence: what does this cue change in the student's thinking process? What habit does it install or what error does it interrupt?
Follow-Up Action	What drill, position, or exercise do you assign immediately after delivering this cue to reinforce it?
Module 2 Link	Which lesson, drill, or unit in Module 2: Tactical & Calculation Progression System™ does this cue connect to for deeper curriculum work?
Notes	Any additional context — student age, time control, position type, or setting where this cue works especially well.

🗒 Copy this template for as many cues as you develop. Over a full coaching year, a coach delivering 5–10 lessons per week will generate dozens of field-tested personal cues worth capturing.

What This Bonus Delivers

The quality of your coaching corrections directly determines the speed of your students' improvement. Vague language produces slow learning. Precise language — delivered at the exact moment of error — produces transformation.

Pattern Recognition

Cues for forks, pins, skewers, discovered attacks, and combined patterns — organized by the exact error, not the general topic.

Calculation & Visualization

Cues for depth failures, missed forcing moves, ghost pieces, and visualization breakdowns — the engine of tactical accuracy.

Decision Making

Cues for first-move bias, one-move thinking, and defensive resource blindness — the discipline layer above raw calculation.

This library works hand-in-hand with **Module 2: Tactical & Calculation Progression System™** — the full teaching curriculum that takes students from tactical beginner to competitive calculator. Use this bonus to sharpen your in-lesson language; use Module 2 to build the underlying skill architecture. Together, they form a complete tactical coaching system.

> The coach who can name the error precisely, deliver the right cue instantly, and assign the right follow-up without hesitation — that coach produces measurable improvement, lesson after lesson. That is what this library is built to give you.